

doc-spirit-regeneration

Affirms · Pneumatology › Work · doctrine · unanimous_lineages · confidence: high

Statement under examination

The Holy Spirit is the agent of regeneration, granting new birth to those dead in sin.

Rationale

Pan-canonical lexical demonstration. John 3:5-8 (γεννηθῆ ἐξ ὕδατος καὶ πνεύματος gennēthē ex hydatos kai pneumatōs G1080 plus G5204 plus G4151 'born of water and the Spirit'; γεννηθῆ ἄνωθεν gennēthē anōthen 'born from above'; τὸ γεγεννημένον ἐκ τοῦ πνεύματος πνεῦμά ἐστιν 'that which is born of the Spirit is spirit') makes new birth the Spirit's act and the condition for entering the kingdom. Titus 3:5 (διὰ λουτροῦ παλιγγενεσίας καὶ ἀνακαινώσεως πνεύματος ἁγίου dia loutrou palingenesias kai anakainōseōs pneumatōs hagiou G3067 plus G3824 plus G342 plus G4151 plus G40 'through the washing of regeneration and renewal of the Holy Spirit') explicitly names the Holy Spirit as the agent of regeneration and renewal. Ezek 36:25-27 supplies the OT canonical anchor: God himself sprinkles clean water, gives a new heart (לֵב חַדָּשׁ leḅ chadash H3820 plus H2319), a new spirit (רוּחַ חַדָּשׁ ruach chadashah H7307 plus H2319), and puts his Spirit within so that the people walk in his statutes. The act is divine, not human. 1 Pet 1:3 and 1:23 (ἀναγεννήσας anagennēsas G313 aorist active participle, 'having begotten us again') and James 1:18 (ἀπεκύησεν apekyēsen G616 'he brought us forth by the word of truth') predicate the new birth of God's initiative. John 1:13 ('born not of blood nor of the will of the flesh nor of the will of man, but of God') excludes every human originating cause. John 6:63 ('the Spirit gives life, the flesh profits nothing', τὸ πνεῦμα ἐστιν τὸ ζωοποιοῦν G4151 plus G2227) seals the Spirit's life-giving role. 1 John 5:1 (πᾶς ὁ πιστεύων ὅτι Ἰησοῦς ἐστιν ὁ Χριστὸς ἐκ τοῦ θεοῦ γεγέννηται; γεγέννηται is perfect indicative middle/passive of γεννάω G1080, 'has been born of God', a past act with abiding present effect) shows the new birth of God as a fixed standing.

Reasoning

Verdict: the Holy Spirit is the one who makes a person spiritually alive. Without his work, no one can enter the kingdom of God or believe in Jesus in a saving way. The strongest reason from Scripture is John chapter 3. Jesus tells Nicodemus, 'Unless one is born again, he cannot see the kingdom of God,' and then, 'Unless one is born of water and the Spirit, he cannot enter the kingdom of God.' Jesus compares the Spirit's work to the wind, which blows where it wishes, and says that this is how it is with everyone born of the Spirit. The Spirit acts; the human being is the one acted upon. Titus 3:5 names the work directly: 'He saved us, not because of works done by us in righteousness, but according to his own mercy, by the washing of regeneration and renewal of the Holy Spirit.' Ezekiel 36 promised this centuries before Christ: 'I will give you a new heart, and a new spirit I will put within you. And I will remove the heart of stone from your flesh and give you a heart of flesh. And I will put my Spirit within you, and cause you to walk in my statutes.' First Peter 1:3 says God 'caused us to be born again to a living hope through the resurrection of Jesus Christ from the dead.' James 1:18 says 'of his own will he brought us forth by the word of truth.' Every passage puts God or the Spirit on the active side of the verb and the person on the receiving side. The strongest counterargument inside the Bible is the place of human faith and human responsibility. John 3:16 says 'whoever believes in him' will have eternal life. Romans 10:9-10 says that confessing with the mouth and believing in the heart saves. Acts 16:31 says 'believe in the Lord Jesus, and you will be saved.' Critics inside the church ask, if the Spirit must regenerate the person first, what becomes of human responsibility to believe. The biblical answer holds both sides together. First John 5:1 says, 'Everyone who believes that Jesus is the Christ has been born of God.' The grammar of that verse places the new birth before the believing, as the cause that makes the believing possible. The Spirit makes the dead person

alive, and the now-alive person believes. Ephesians 2:1-5 says we were 'dead in trespasses' and that God 'made us alive together with Christ.' Dead people do not choose life; the living God gives life, and the now-alive person responds in faith. Responsibility to believe remains real, but it is the response of a regenerated heart, not the cause of regeneration.

Denominational landscape

Every historic Christian lineage affirms that the Holy Spirit is the agent of regeneration. The substantive disagreement is on WHEN and HOW the Spirit regenerates, and it is the heart of the paedobaptist-vs-credobaptist divide. The Roman Catholic Catechism (paragraph 1213) teaches baptismal regeneration: baptism is the sacrament of regeneration through water in the word, freeing from sin and rebirthing as sons of God. Eastern Orthodoxy holds the same shape, treating baptism as new birth by water and the Holy Spirit. Classical Lutheran teaching (Augsburg IX) and high-church Anglican teaching (39 Articles 27) similarly tie regeneration to baptism, though the Anglican tradition has internally debated this since the Gorham case of 1850. Reformed and Baptist traditions distinguish the Spirit's inward regenerating work from the outward baptismal sign: the Westminster Confession teaches that regeneration is the sovereign work of the Spirit applying the gospel; Baptists and most evangelicals hold that regeneration occurs at conversion when the Spirit applies the word to the heart, and that water baptism follows as a public testimony. Methodist, Pentecostal and Anabaptist traditions also locate regeneration at the new birth in conversion. The agreement across lineages is that the Spirit alone regenerates. The disagreement is on the means and timing of that work. Public-record carriers of denial that the Spirit regenerates at all are rare. Religious traditions that deny the very category of new birth (some forms of liberal-mainline reductionism that treat conversion as merely psychological) collapse the doctrine, but most contemporary Christians inside any of the named lineages affirm Spirit-wrought regeneration as the core doctrine.

Position thresholds

Would die for if challenged	Yes
Cult marker if denied	Yes
Would visit if otherwise	No
Would participate if otherwise	No
Would serve if otherwise	No
Would be member if otherwise	No
Would let children be taught otherwise	No
Would marry if held otherwise	No
Would publicly correct if otherwise	Yes

Notes

The COMMON doctrine that the Holy Spirit is the agent of the new birth is universal in historic Christianity. Every tracked lineage affirms it. The disagreement is on the MEANS and TIMING of the Spirit's regenerating work, not on the agent. The Catholic, Eastern Orthodox, classical Lutheran, and (within Anglicanism) high-church Anglican traditions tie regeneration to baptism: the Spirit regenerates the baptized through the water-rite, including in infants. The Reformed, Baptist, free-church, Anabaptist, and most evangelical and Pentecostal traditions tie regeneration to the Spirit's effectual application of the gospel at conversion, treating baptism as the sign and seal of an already-given regeneration (in the

Reformed paedo line) or as the believer's confession of a faith already wrought (in the credo line). This baptismal-regeneration vs. monergistic-conversion-regeneration divide is the substantive paedobaptist-versus-credobaptist line, and it is in-house Christian, not a gospel-stake. The gospel-stake is the proposition itself: that no one enters the kingdom of God without the Spirit's regenerating work (John 3:3, 5, 8). Denial of THAT collapses the gospel, because it would make natural humans capable of saving themselves apart from divine regeneration, and would contradict the unambiguous lexical text of John 3, Titus 3:5, Ezek 36, and 1 Pet 1. Public-record carriers of denial: Pelagius and his modern theological heirs (whose system denies the necessity of regenerating grace, treating sin as imitation rather than nature and salvation as moral effort), classical Socinianism, modern theological liberalism (which reduces regeneration to moral self-improvement or social transformation), Mormonism (which constructs salvation as a process of moral and ordinance-based progression toward godhood without affirming the canonical doctrine of Spirit-wrought new birth from spiritual death), Jehovah's Witnesses (who restrict 'born again' language to the 144,000 anointed class, not to all believers, contrary to John 3:5-8's universal 'unless ANYONE is born of water and the Spirit'), Christadelphians (who deny the personality of the Holy Spirit and reduce regeneration to mental enlightenment), Christian Science (Mary Baker Eddy treats sin and death as illusion, eliminating the canonical category of spiritual death from which regeneration delivers), Unitarian Universalism (which reduces new birth to ethical awakening). The fruit-vs-precision nuance: most believers will not articulate either the monergistic-effectual-call model or the sacramental-instrumental model, but they confess that they were dead in sin and that God by his Spirit gave them new life. That functional confession is the canonical doctrine. The in-house divide on timing must not be flattened into a gospel-stake. Trusted-elder review should clarify the user's own stance on the means-of-application question (baptismal vs. converting work of the Spirit) without making it a cult-marker line.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. covenant_theology, new_covenant_theology, sacramental_realism, credo_baptist_monergism, synergism

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

Competing lens verdicts

· affirms:

· affirms:

· affirms:

· affirms:

· affirms:

Every tracked framework affirms the Holy Spirit as the agent of regeneration. The disagreement is on means (sacramental vs. word-and-Spirit) and timing (at baptism vs. at conversion). The pan-canonical lemma network is unambiguous on the agent: gennaō G1080 in John 1:13, 3:3-8, 1 John 5:1 (every instance with God or the Spirit as agent); anagennaō G313 in 1 Pet 1:3, 23 (God as agent both times); apokueō G616 in James 1:18 (God as subject); zōopoieō G2227 in John 6:63 of the Spirit; syzōopoieō G4806 in Eph 2:5 of God; palingenesia G3824 and anakainōsis G342 in Titus 3:5 explicitly attached to the Holy Spirit; nathan H5414 plus ruach H7307 in Ezek 11:19 and 36:26-27 of YHWH's own Spirit. Analogia scripturae is invoked at the complicating passages (Acts 16:31, John 1:12, Acts 2:38, Matt 28:19, Rom 6:4) to integrate human responsibility and the role of baptism without reassigning the agency. Progressive revelation: Ezek 36 and Jer 31 promise the heart-and-Spirit work, John 3 stipulates it as the condition of the kingdom, Titus 3:5 names it explicitly as the Holy Spirit's regenerating-and-renewing act, 1 Pet 1 and James 1 add the instrumental role of the word of truth, 1 John 5:1 fixes the perfect-tense standing

Scripture (apparatus + interlinear)

John.3.3 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. ἐὰν μὴ τις γεννηθῇ ἄνωθεν οὐ δύναται ἰδεῖν τὴν βασιλείαν τοῦ θεοῦ; gennaō G1080 aorist passive subjunctive 3s; anōthen G509

Force. 'Unless one is born again (or from above), he cannot see the kingdom of God.' The passive of gennaō with the divine agent implied places the new birth as something done TO the person. Anōthen has the double sense 'again' and 'from above'; John exploits both (Nicodemus hears 'again' at v.4, Jesus presses 'from above / of the Spirit' at v.5-6). Categorical denial of natural human ability to see the kingdom apart from this birth

John.3.5 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. ἐὰν μὴ τις γεννηθῇ ἐξ ὕδατος καὶ πνεύματος; pneuma G4151; gennaō G1080 aorist passive subjunctive

Force. 'Unless one is born of water and the Spirit, he cannot enter the kingdom of God.' Single preposition ex governing both hydatos and pneumatosis: one composite source of the new birth. Echoes Ezek 36:25-27 (water of cleansing plus the gift of the Spirit) as the OT background. Spirit is the agent; water imagery signals the cleansing that the Spirit effects. Note: traditions that read 'water' as the baptismal rite tie regeneration to baptism; traditions that read 'water' as the Ezek 36 OT-promise cleansing tie it to the Spirit's converting work. The agent is the Spirit either way

John.3.6 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. τὸ γεγεννημένον ἐκ τοῦ πνεύματος πνεῦμά ἐστιν; gennaō G1080 perfect passive participle; pneuma G4151

Force. 'That which is born of the flesh is flesh, and that which is born of the Spirit is spirit.' Perfect passive of gennaō ('having been born and remaining so'). Two categorical kinds of birth: natural birth produces fleshly being, Spirit-birth produces spiritual being. No middle ground, no natural pathway to spiritual life

John.3.8 · for · genre: gospel · figures: metaphor, simile

Key term. τὸ πνεῦμα ὅπου θέλει πνεῖ; pneuma G4151; thelō G2309 present active indicative 3s; pneō G4154 present active indicative 3s

Force. 'The wind blows where it wishes, and you hear its sound, but you do not know where it comes from or where it goes. So it is with everyone who is born of the Spirit.' Pneuma is used with double force: the wind (which the analogy traces) and the Spirit (the antitype). The Spirit's regenerating work is sovereign and mysterious in its operation, not subject to human control or prediction. Affirms the divine agency of the new birth

John.1.13 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. οἱ οὐκ ἐξ αἱμάτων οὐδὲ ἐκ θελήματος σαρκὸς οὐδὲ ἐκ θελήματος ἀνδρὸς ἀλλ' ἐκ θεοῦ ἐγεννήθησαν; gennaō G1080 aorist passive indicative 3p; thelēma G2307

Force. 'Who were born, not of blood nor of the will of the flesh nor of the will of man, but of God.' Triple negation excludes every human-originating cause (lineage, fleshly desire, male volition) and isolates the single divine source (ek theou). Aorist passive locates the new birth as a definite past act done by God to the believer

Titus.3.5 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. διὰ λουτροῦ παλιγγενεσίας καὶ ἀνακαινώσεως πνεύματος ἁγίου; loutron G3067; palingenesia G3824; anakainōsis G342; pneuma hagion G4151 plus G40

Force. 'He saved us, not because of works done by us in righteousness, but according to his own mercy, by the washing of regeneration and renewal of the Holy Spirit.' Loutron G3067 is washing (Eph 5:26 uses it of the cleansing of the church by the word). Palingenesia G3824 occurs in the NT only here and at Matt 19:28 (the cosmic regeneration); here applied to personal new birth. Anakainōsis G342 is the parallel renewal-noun (cf. Rom 12:2). The Holy Spirit is the explicit agent (genitive pneumatōs hagiou modifying anakainōseōs and reaching back to palingenesias)

Ezek.36.25 · for · genre: prophecy · figures: metaphor

Key term. מִיָּדָי אֶשְׁפֹּךְ מַיִם טְהוֹרִים; zaraq H2236 piel; mayim H4325; tahor H2889

Force. 'I will sprinkle clean water on you, and you shall be clean from all your uncleannesses, and from all your idols I will cleanse you.' God himself is the agent (first-person verbs throughout vv.25-27). The cleansing is divine, not self-administered. Establishes the OT canonical pattern that John 3:5 echoes: water plus Spirit as the divine cleansing-and-renewing work

Ezek.36.26 · for · genre: prophecy · figures: metaphor

Key term. וְהָיָה לְכָל בָּשָׂר לֵב עֹשֶׂה חֵן; nathan H5414; leb H3820; chadash H2319; ruach H7307

Force. 'I will give you a new heart, and a new spirit I will put within you. And I will remove the heart of stone from your flesh and give you a heart of flesh.' First-person divine agency. The heart-transplant is unilateral and effectual. Recipient does not cooperate in the giving; the recipient is the patient of the verb

Ezek.36.27 · for · genre: prophecy

Key term. וְכָל־תְּהַלְכַּתְּךָ־בְּפָנַי וְשָׁמַרְתָּ־אֶת־חֻצֹתַי וְהָלַכְתָּ־בְּחֻצֹתַי וְשָׁמַרְתָּ־אֶת־חֻצֹתַי; ruach H7307; nathan H5414; halak H1980

Force. 'And I will put my Spirit within you, and cause you to walk in my statutes and be careful to obey my rules.' My Spirit (ruchi, first-person possessive of YHWH's own Spirit) is the indwelling agent. Causation language: God himself causes the walking, not merely commands it. Canonical OT background for new-covenant regeneration

Ezek.11.19 · for · genre: prophecy · figures: metaphor

Key term. וְהָיָה־לָּהֶם־לֵב־אֶחָד וְרוּחַ־אֶחָד־יִשְׁכַּח־בָּם וְהָיָה־לָּהֶם־לֵב־בָּשָׂר וְהָיָה־לָּהֶם־לֵב־אֶחָד וְרוּחַ־אֶחָד־יִשְׁכַּח־בָּם; nathan H5414; leb H3820; ruach H7307

Force. 'And I will give them one heart, and a new spirit I will put within them. I will remove the heart of stone from their flesh and give them a heart of flesh.' Parallel to Ezek 36:26 (the doubled prophetic promise). Confirms the canonical pattern: God gives the new heart and spirit unilaterally; this is not the people's reform but God's action upon them

Jer.31.33 · for · genre: prophecy

Key term. וְהָיָה־לְיִשְׂרָאֵל־כְּבָרִית וְהָיָה־לְיִשְׂרָאֵל־כְּבָרִית וְהָיָה־לְיִשְׂרָאֵל־כְּבָרִית וְהָיָה־לְיִשְׂרָאֵל־כְּבָרִית; nathan H5414; torah H8451; leb H3820; kathab H3789

Force. 'I will put my law within them, and I will write it on their hearts. And I will be their God, and they shall be my people.' New-covenant promise of internal divine work on the heart. The agent is YHWH; the recipients are the patients of the writing. Background to NT new-birth language, cited at Heb 8:10 and 10:16

1Pet.1.3 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ὁ ἀναγεννήσας ἡμᾶς; anagennaō G313 aorist active participle nominative masculine singular

Force. 'Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ! According to his great mercy, he has caused us to be born again to a living hope through the resurrection of Jesus Christ from the dead.' Anagennaō G313 ('to beget again') occurs in the NT only here and at 1 Pet 1:23; both times God is the subject. Aorist active participle with definite article: God is the begetter, believers are the begotten

1Pet.1.23 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἀναγεγεννημένοι οὐκ ἐκ σποράς φθαρτῆς ἀλλὰ ἀφθάρτου διὰ λόγου ζῶντος θεοῦ; anagennaō G313 perfect passive participle; spora G4701; phthartos G5349; aphthartos G862; logos G3056

Force. 'Since you have been born again, not of perishable seed but of imperishable, through the living and abiding word of God.' Perfect passive participle: completed action with abiding effect. The instrumental phrase dia logou ('through the word') names the means by which God begets; the Spirit's work attaches to the word of the gospel

James.1.18 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key term. βουλῆθεῖς ἀπεκύησεν ἡμᾶς λόγῳ ἀληθείας; apokueō G616 aorist active indicative 3s; boulomai G1014 aorist passive participle; logos G3056; alētheia G225

Force. 'Of his own will he brought us forth by the word of truth, that we should be a kind of firstfruits of his creatures.' Boulētheis (aorist passive participle of boulomai, 'having willed') makes the new birth God's own decree. Apokueō G616 ('to bring forth as a mother to a child') puts God in the active role and believers in the passive. The instrument is logos alētheias, the word of truth, paralleling 1 Pet 1:23

John.6.63 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. τὸ πνεῦμά ἐστιν τὸ ζῶοποιεῖν ἡ σὰρξ οὐκ ὠφελεῖ οὐδέν; pneuma G4151; zōopoieō G2227 present active participle; sarx G4561; ὀpheleō G5623

Force. 'It is the Spirit who gives life; the flesh is of no avail.' Zōopoieō G2227 (to make alive, to quicken) is predicated of the Spirit. The contrast with sarx ('the flesh profits nothing') excludes any natural-human source of spiritual life. Directly grounds the Spirit's agency in giving spiritual life

1John.5.1 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. πᾶς ὁ πιστεύων ὅτι Ἰησοῦς ἐστιν ὁ Χριστὸς ἐκ τοῦ θεοῦ γεγέννηται; gennaō G1080 perfect passive indicative 3s; pisteuō G4100 present active participle

Force. 'Everyone who believes that Jesus is the Christ has been born of God.' Gegennētai is perfect passive ('has been born and remains so'). Word order and tense place the new birth as the standing reality that grounds the present believing, not the reward for it. The Reformed reading of this verse treats the perfect as causal of the present participle pisteuōn; sacramental readings allow the same temporal priority with regeneration in baptism preceding adult confession

Eph.2.1 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key term. νεκροὺς τοῖς παραπτώμασιν καὶ ταῖς ἁμαρτίαις; nekros G3498; paraptōma G3900; hamartia G266

Force. 'And you were dead in the trespasses and sins.' Categorical predicate of spiritual death over all natural humans prior to grace. Establishes the canonical anthropology that regeneration presupposes: the regenerated person is brought from death to life, not from weakness to strength

Eph.2.5 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key term. συνεζωοποίησεν τῷ Χριστῷ; syzōopoieō G4806 aorist active indicative 3s

Force. 'Even when we were dead in our trespasses, made us alive together with Christ.' God (the subject of v.4-5) is the one who makes alive. Syzōopoieō shares the zōopoieō root with John 6:63. The dead person does not cooperate in being made alive; resurrection-language for regeneration

2Cor.5.17 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. εἴ τις ἐν Χριστῷ καινὴ κτίσις; kainos G2537; ktisis G2937

Force. 'If anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away; behold, the new has come.' Kainē ktisis ('new creation'; kainos = qualitatively new, not merely chronologically recent) describes the regenerated person. The act of new creation is on the divine side; humans cannot create themselves

John.1.12 · complicates · genre: gospel

Key term. ἔδωκεν αὐτοῖς ἐξουσίαν τέκνα θεοῦ γενέσθαι τοῖς πιστεύουσιν εἰς τὸ ὄνομα αὐτοῦ; didōmi G1325; exousia G1849; teknon G5043; pisteuō G4100 present active participle

Force. 'To all who did receive him, who believed in his name, he gave the right to become children of God.' The verse names human believing as the responsive side. Read with v.13 (which immediately follows: 'who were born, not of blood, nor of the will of the flesh, nor of the will of man, but of God'), the giving of the right to become children of God is grounded in the divine act of new birth, not the other way around. Complicates only on a flat read; coheres on the canonical read

Acts.16.31 · complicates · genre: narrative

Key term. πίστευσον ἐπὶ τὸν κύριον Ἰησοῦν καὶ σωθήσῃ; pisteuō G4100 aorist active imperative 2s; sōzō G4982 future passive indicative 2s

Force. 'Believe in the Lord Jesus, and you will be saved, you and your household.' The imperative places the responsibility to believe on the hearer. Read in isolation, it might suggest faith as the unconditional cause of salvation. Read with John 6:44, 65 (no one can come to Jesus unless the Father draws him) and 1 John 5:1, the imperative to believe is genuine but addressed to those whose ability to obey it is itself the Spirit's gift. Complicates the agency picture only on a flat read

Matt.28.19 · complicates · genre: gospel

Key term. βαπτίζοντες αὐτοὺς εἰς τὸ ὄνομα τοῦ πατρὸς καὶ τοῦ υἱοῦ καὶ τοῦ ἁγίου πνεύματος; baptizō G907 present active participle

Force. 'Baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit.' Read sacramentally, ties baptism to incorporation into the Triune name and to the Spirit's regenerating work in the rite. Read symbolically, treats baptism as the believer's public profession of an already-given regeneration. The text itself does not adjudicate the timing question; both readings appeal to the same words. Complicates only insofar as it touches the in-house paedocredo divide on means and timing

Acts.2.38 · complicates · genre: narrative

Key term. μετανοήσατε καὶ βαπτισθήτω ἕκαστος ὑμῶν λήμψεσθε τὴν δωρεὰν τοῦ ἁγίου πνεύματος; metanoeō G3340 aorist active imperative; baptizō G907 aorist passive imperative; dōrea G1431

Force. 'Repent and be baptized every one of you in the name of Jesus Christ for the forgiveness of your sins, and you will receive the gift of the Holy Spirit.' Sacramental readings treat the conjunction of baptism with the gift of the Spirit as tying regeneration to the rite. Free-church readings note that v.41 specifies 'those who received his word' as the baptized, treating prior faith as the condition. The verse complicates the timing question but does not deny that the Holy Spirit is the agent of new life

Rom.6.4 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key term. συνετάφημεν οὖν αὐτῷ διὰ τοῦ βαπτίσματος εἰς τὸν θάνατον; synthaptō G4916 aorist passive indicative; baptisma G908

Force. 'We were buried therefore with him by baptism into death, in order that, just as Christ was raised from the dead by the glory of the Father, we too might walk in newness of life.' Ties baptism to union with Christ's death and resurrection. The text supports both sacramental readings (the rite effects union) and symbolic readings (the rite signifies union already wrought by the Spirit through faith). Complicates the in-house question without overturning the agent

Concordance lemmas traversed

G1080, G509, G4151, G5204, G3067, G3824, G342, G40, G313, G616, G3056, G225, G4701, G5349, G862, G2227, G4561, G5623, G4154, G2309, G4100, G2307, G3498, G3900, G266, G4806, G2537, G2937, G1325, G1849, G5043, G4982, G3340, G907, G908, G4916, G1431, G3173, H5414, H3820, H2319, H7307, H1320, H68, H2236, H4325, H2889, H1980, H259, H5493, H8451, H3789

complicating texts searched: Yes

Counter-witness traditions

patristic · Augustine, On the Spirit and the Letter, On Rebuke and Grace (NPNF1 Vol 5); Cyril of Jerusalem, Catechetical Lectures on baptism and the Spirit; Gregory of Nazianzus, Oration 40 (On Holy Baptism) · affirms · unverified

“Patristic consensus: regeneration is the work of the Holy Spirit, given through baptism. Augustine writes that the Spirit alone gives the new heart against Pelagius; Cyril and Gregory teach baptism as the laver of regeneration”

catholic_magisterial · Catechism of the Catholic Church 1213-1284 on baptism (vatican.va); CCC 1213, 1215, 1262-1266 specifically on regeneration · affirms · verified

“CCC 1213: 'Through Baptism we are freed from sin and reborn as sons of God; we become members of Christ.' Baptism is 'the sacrament of regeneration through water in the word.' The Holy Spirit regenerates in the rite”

lutheran · Augsburg Confession Article IX; Luther's Small Catechism Part IV on Holy Baptism; Formula of Concord Solid Declaration XI (bookofconcord.org) · affirms · verified

“Augsburg IX: 'Baptism is necessary to salvation, and through Baptism is offered the grace of God.' Small Catechism: baptism 'works forgiveness of sins, rescues from death and the devil, and gives eternal salvation”

anglican · 39 Articles, Article XXVII, Of Baptism; Book of Common Prayer baptismal liturgy · affirms · unverified

“Article XXVII: baptism is 'a sign of regeneration or new birth, whereby, as by an instrument, they that receive Baptism rightly are grafted into the Church.' The Anglican tradition has internally debated since the Gorham case (1850) whether regeneration is conveyed in the rite or only signified”

reformed · Westminster Confession of Faith 10.1-10.2 (effectual calling) and 28.5-28.6 (baptism not necessarily tied to the moment of regeneration); Heidelberg Catechism Q&A 8, 65-74; 1689 London Baptist Confession chapter 10 · affirms · unverified

“WCF 10.1-10.2: those whom God effectually calls 'he is pleased to enlighten their minds spiritually and savingly... renewing their wills, and by his almighty power determining them to that which is good, and effectually drawing them to Jesus Christ'. Regeneration the Spirit's monergistic work”

methodist · United Methodist Articles of Religion, Article XVII, Of Baptism (umc.org); Wesley's Notes on the New Testament on John 3 and Titus 3:5 · affirms · verified

“Article XVII: 'Baptism is not only a sign of profession and mark of difference whereby Christians are distinguished from others that are not baptized; but it is also a sign of regeneration or the new birth.' Wesley's abridgement preserves the Anglican formula”

anabaptist · Schleithem Confession 1527 Article 1, Of Baptism; Dordrecht Confession 1632 Articles 6-7 on repentance and baptism · affirms · unverified

“Schleithem Article 1: baptism is for 'all those who have learned repentance and amendment of life, and who believe truly that their sins are taken away by Christ'. Regeneration precedes baptism; baptism is the believer's confession of an already-wrought Spirit-work”

pentecostal · Assemblies of God Statement of Fundamental Truths, Truth 5, The Salvation of Man, and Truth 8, The Initial Physical Evidence of the Baptism in the Holy Spirit (ag.org) · affirms · unverified

“AG: 'Man's only hope of redemption is through the shed blood of Jesus Christ.' New birth is the Spirit's regenerating work received through faith; the subsequent baptism in the Holy Spirit is a distinct empowerment for service”

eastern_orthodox · OCA, The Orthodox Faith, Worship, The Sacrament of Baptism (oca.org); Nicene-Constantinopolitan Creed: 'I confess one baptism for the remission of sins' · affirms · verified

“OCA: baptism is 'a new birth by water and the Holy Spirit into the Kingdom of God.' Regeneration is the Holy Spirit's work in the rite, with the Spirit personally given through the connected sacrament of chrismation”

Web sources

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/john/3-5.htm>

“John 3:5: gennēthē ex hydatos kai pneumatōs. Single preposition ex governs both nouns, one composite source: birth of water and the Spirit. Echoes Ezek 36:25-27”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/titus/3-5.htm>

“Titus 3:5: loutron palingenesias kai anakainōseōs pneumatōs hagiou. The washing of regeneration and renewal of the Holy Spirit. Spirit is the explicit agent in the genitive”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/ezekiel/36-26.htm>

“Ezek 36:26: 'I will give you a new heart, and a new spirit I will put within you.' nathan H5414 plus leb H3820 plus chadash H2319 plus ruach H7307. First-person divine agency throughout”

supports · category: interlinear · https://biblehub.com/interlinear/1_peter/1-3.htm

“1 Pet 1:3: anagennaō G313 aorist participle, 'having begotten us again.' God the Father is the subject. The same verb at 1 Pet 1:23. Only NT occurrences, both with God as agent”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/james/1-18.htm>

“James 1:18: apokueō G616, 'he brought us forth by the word of truth.' God the active subject; believers brought forth. Of his own will (boulētheis)”

supports · category: interlinear · https://biblehub.com/interlinear/1_john/5-1.htm

“1 John 5:1: ek tou theou gegennētai. Perfect passive of gennaō. 'Has been born of God' with abiding present effect. Word order places the new birth as the standing reality grounding the believing”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/john/6-63.htm>

“John 6:63: 'the Spirit is the one giving life'. Zōopoieō G2227 of the Spirit. The flesh profits nothing. Excludes any natural-human source of spiritual life”

supports · category: magisterial · https://www.vatican.va/archive/ENG0015/___P3G.HTM

“CCC 1213: 'Through Baptism we are freed from sin and reborn as sons of God; we become members of Christ, are incorporated into the Church.' Baptism: the sacrament of regeneration”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://www.oca.org/orthodoxy/the-orthodox-faith/worship/the-sacraments/baptism>

“OCA: 'Christian baptism is man's participation in the event of Easter. It is a new birth by water and the Holy Spirit into the Kingdom of God.' Regeneration tied to the rite”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://www.umc.org/en/content/articles-of-religion>

“UMC Article XVII on Baptism: 'Baptism is... a sign of regeneration or the new birth.' Wesley's abridgement of the 39 Articles preserves the regeneration language”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://bookofconcord.org/augsburg-confession/>

“Augsburg IX: 'Of Baptism they teach that it is necessary to salvation, and that through Baptism is offered the grace of God.' Lutheran sacramental affirmation”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strongsgreek/313.htm>

“anagennaō G313, NT only at 1 Pet 1:3, 23, both times of God regenerating a believer. Does not occur in classical or Septuagint Greek”

Flags

- in-house-paedo-credo-divide-on-means-and-timing